

"THEY SAID I RIGGED THE 1983 POLLS, BUT COULDN'T PROVE IT."



Farooq Abdullah

A landslide victory for the National Conference-Congress alliance in the Jammu and Kashmir elections of March should have been cause for celebration, but Farooq Abdullah's return to power in the state was tainted by charges of rigging and electoral bungling. That was lent credence by the fact that it was the only state where results remained unannounced for a week. Even as the results were coming in, the new government was busy arresting top Muslim United Front leaders. Starting two weeks before the elections, about 600 Opposition party workers were in jail.

Meerut on the Boil

Nine days of communal violence in Meerut caused the death of over 150 and left over 1,000 injured. The frenzied rioting was set off by an insignificant incident when the police broke in on an Iftar session of a Muslim family to pick up a murder suspect.



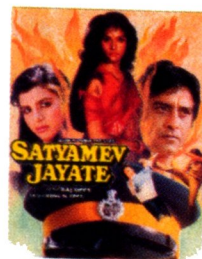
THE BLASTER

On March 7, 'Little Master' Sunil Gavaskar became the first batsman in the world to score 10,000 runs in Test cricket.



THE OTHER STAR

Former Osho acolyte Vinod Khanna made a storming comeback, challenging Amitabh Bachchan's dominance in Bollywood with the release of two blockbusters *Insaaf* and *Satyamev Jayate*, both of which touched 100 per cent first-week collections across most of India.



ELSEWHERE.

- US President Ronald Reagan addressed the nation on the Iran-Contra affair, acknowledging that overtures to Iran had 'deteriorated' into an arms-for-hostages deal.
- The Chadian army (below) destroyed a Libyan brigade in Battle of Fada, a decisive event in the 1978-87 Libyan-Chadian War.



- The first successful heart-lung transplant took place in Baltimore, Maryland, in the US.
- The Dow Jones industrial average closed above 2,000, ending the day at 2002.25.
- British stores released the first Beatles compact discs.

40,000

was the number of people who were killed in road accidents throughout the country. Another 1.75 lakh were injured.

3,20,000

was the total number of registered medical practitioners in India.